Pfizer Inc. (PFE): 2Q26 Earnings Preview: Expecting In-Line Results with Soft COVID Franchise, Amidst Cautious Broader Outlook

Asad Haider, CFA
+1(212)902-0691 | asad.haider@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Nick Jennings
+1(415)249-7412 |
nick.jennings@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Jeff Su
+1(212)357-9930 | jeff.su@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Despite its relatively low valuation (8.75x 2027 P/E vs pharma peer mean/median 14.5x/14x) PFE shares have continued to lag peers YTD (+0.4% vs DRG +10%) with recent newsflow (announcement of the CFO departure followed by a notable pipeline setback) weighing further on sentiment with growing debates on the prospects for capital allocation, the dividend, and the pipeline.

It is in this backdrop that company will be reporting its 2Q26 earnings (Aug 4th) where we expect a generally in-line set of results (aside from a widely expected Paxlovid miss given COVID trends — see key variances within). We note some investors are likely anticipating a potential guidance raise given management's framing on the 1Q earnings call of upside convexity to 2026 revenue guidance with the commercial progress noted in 1Q across parts of the portfolio, although the prospects for a raise this quarter could be offset by the COVID headwinds and leadership transition.

More so than quarterly performance, delivering on upcoming 2H26 clinical readouts (mevrometostat, GLP-1/amylin combo) now seems increasingly important to regain investor confidence in the pipeline, given low investor tolerance/increasingly less flexibility for any additional disappointments. We've recently fielded growing interest in the imminent Ph3 readout for mevrometostat (EZH2 inhibitor for prostate cancer, primary completion date July 2026), which we see as +/- ~3% swing factor on our valuation (see within). To that end, we will be listening for updates here, as well as any incremental signals of BD activity, where the company currently has ~$7 billion in BD capacity, and the current strategic focus is on pipeline bolt-ons, although management has highlighted flexibility to pursue larger deals if attractive opportunities arise. While recent quarterly results have showcased steady operational execution, and 2Q earnings could continue that trend, we expect these longer-term considerations to continue to dominate the narrative on the stock.

Details within.

Considerations Into 2Q26 Earnings

Exhibit 1: 2Q26 GS vs. Consensus: Income Statement

GS vs. Visible Alpha Consensus	2Q26		
Income Statement:	**GS**	**Consensus**	**Variance**
Total Revenue	**$14,561**	**$14,378**	**1.3%**
COGS	$3,480	$3,400	2.3%
Gross Profit	**$11,081**	**$10,978**	**0.9%**
R&D	$2,679	$2,668	0.4%
SG&A	$3,305	$3,260	1.4%
Adj. EBIT ex. IPR&D	**$5,096**	**$5,050**	**0.9%**
Adj. EPS including guided IPR&D	**$0.69**	**$0.68**	**2.2%**
Margins:	**GS**	**Consensus**	**Variance**
Gross Margin	76.1%	76.3%	(-25)bps
R&D % of Revenue	18.4%	18.6%	(-16)bps
SG&A % of Revenue	22.7%	22.7%	3bps

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

Exhibit 2: 2Q26 GS vs. Consensus: Sales Model

GS vs. Visible Alpha Consensus	2Q26E		
Key Product GS vs. Consensus	**GS**	**Consensus**	**Variance**
Primary Care:			
Eliquis	$2,132	$2,067	3.1%
Prevnar Family	$1,373	$1,368	0.3%
Comirnaty	$238	$236	1.1%
Paxlovid	$145	$161	-10.0%
Abrysvo	$129	$137	-5.8%
Nurtec	$433	$425	2.1%
Speciality Care:			
Vyndaqel Family	$1,674	$1,704	-1.7%
Xeljanz	$188	$197	-4.6%
All Other Hospital	$970	$923	5.0%
Oncology:			
Ibrance	$1,004	$976	2.9%
Padcev	$649	$628	3.2%
Xtandi	$521	$516	0.8%
Adcetris	$200	$222	-9.8%
Lorbrena	$317	$312	1.7%
Tukysa	$129	$137	-6.3%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

- **Topline Headwinds From a Number of Products vs. 2Q25 Comps:** For 2Q26 results, we note that there are several product-level headwinds vs. 2Q25, including, in the order of magnitude, **1) Seagen products**- Padcev, Adcetris, Tukysa, and Tivdak- saw a one-time favorable impact of ~ 2-3 weeks of sales in 2Q25 per wholesaler transition; **2) Paxlovid-** favorable rebate accruals in 2Q25; **3) Xeljanz**- one-time favorable adjustment in US in 2Q25; and **4) Abrysvo-** favorable US net sales adjustment in 2Q25.

- **Other Product Level Dynamics: 1) COVID -** incidence and virus waste water activity remains low, and TRx (although volatile historical pricing comps and inventory stocking) is -77% and -72% Y/Y and Q/Q; we look for updated commentary regarding the FY26 COVID franchise guidance of $5bn for FY26 vs. GS/Consensus of $4.1bn/$4.5bn; **2) Xeljanz-** US June patent expiration occurred in early 2026, where LOE dynamic occurred throughout the month of June; 2Q26 Xeljanz TRx is -16% Y/Y and -5% Q/Q; **3) Xtandi-** Astellas comments around expectations for sales to decline/growth not expected to return; **4) Eliquis-** we see upside to FY26 Eliquis estimates ($8.7bn vs. Consensus 8.3bn) per BMY comments on Eliquis trending towards the upper range of 10-15% Y/Y growth, and net pricing benefit that will begin in 3Q26 that seems not fully reflected in PFE Consensus estimates; **5) Vyndaqel/Vyndamax-** a further slow down in volume growth, with 2Q26 TRx Y/Y +6% vs. 15% in 1Q26, alongside continued increased GTN per competitive pressure;

and **6) Padcev-** we see upside to FY26 estimates $2.7bn vs. Consensus $2.5bn, as IQVIA data suggests the inflection in growth started in 1Q26 continued into 2Q26, along with the continued ramp of the EV-303 population and recent approval of the EV-304 population.

- **CFO Departure and FY26 Guidance Considerations:** Recall that on June 18th, the company announced that the CFO Dave Denton will be departing on August 15th for a professional opportunity outside of the pharmaceuticals industry. The departure was noted to be amicable/friendly, and that the company has named Cecile Guegan as the Interim CFO. The company reiterated its FY26 guidance on the same day, and given that management framing on the 1Q earnings call of upside convexity to 2026 guidance with commercial progress noted in 1Q26, we do note some investor expectation of a guidance raise, although that expectation could be somewhat tempered given the leadership transition. Here, in our 2Q26 pre-quarter call with the company, it was noted that the new CFO's approach was similar to that of the departing CFO, so philosophy towards guidance should remain status-quo.
- **Capital Allocation:** Prior to the global licensing/collaboration deal with Innovent (with expected acquired IPR&D of $650mn from milestone payments in 3Q26), PFE's remaining BD capacity is ~$7bn. On sizing/TAs of interest, the company continues to focus on smaller bolt-on deals in the company's core therapeutics areas of focus, with flexibility to pursue larger deals if attractive opportunities arise. On the dividend, where the stock's ~7% dividend yield offers some support for PFE shares, the company maintains that the dividend is a core pillar of capital allocation, though we note heightened investor debates here and we look for any updated framing on the earnings call with the interim CFO. We note that dividend payments represented 108% of PFE's free cash flow from operations less CapEx in 2025, vs. median of 64% for US/EU Pharma.

Framing the Upcoming MEVPRO-1 Phase 3 Readout.

- **Context:** With a primary completion date of July 2026, the open-label Ph3 trial MEVPRO-1 studying mevrometostat + enzalutamide (Xtandi) vs. physician's choice of 2L androgen receptor therapy + enzalutamide or docetaxel for 1-2L metastatic castration-resistant prostate cancer (mCRPC) post-abiraterone is expected to readout in 2H26. Given the recent Sig Vedotin set-back in 2L NSCLC, MEVPRO-1 is becoming increasingly important for investor psychology, as it is one of the remaining two major clinical catalysts from the company other than the Ph1/2 GLP-1/Amylin combo reading out in 2H26. The mCRPC market is sizable with $11bn+ across darolutamide, apalutamide, and enzalutamide, and from a strategic perspective, a successful trial and launch of mevrometostat would also serve as a continuation of the company's Xtandi prostate franchise which generated $2.2bn for the company in 2025 (PFE US only) with US substance patents expiring in August 2027.
- **What Has Prior Data Shown:** In the dose-expansion portion of a Ph1 study, mevrometostat 1,250mg BID on an empty stomach + enzalutamide 160mg QD demonstrated improved outcomes vs. enzalutamide alone, although GI tolerability was a main debate. At ASCO GU 2026, updated data from two patient cohorts, part

2A and part 2C who received mevrometostat 875mg BID with food + 160mg enzalutamide QD, demonstrated improved tolerability vs. the higher-dose empty-stomach schedule while maintaining equivalent drug exposure, to which the Ph3 trial MEVPRO-1 will anchor. In Cohort 2A (n=15), which included patients previously treated with abiraterone and/or enzalutamide, the regimen showed a median rPFS of 14.3 months and a PSA50 (>+ 50% reduction in prostate-specific antigen) of 40%; in cohort 2C (n=14) which included patients previously treated with abiraterone and were enzalutamide-naiive, median PFS was not estimable and PSA50 was 42.9%. Of the approved agents, we highlight that Pluvicto demonstrated a mPFS of 11.6 months in its PH3 PSMAforce study in mCRPC patients. On tolerability, for Cohorts 2A and 2C combined, most common TEAEs were diarrhea (48.3%), thrombocytopenia (48.3%), and decreased appetite (44.8%).

- **MEVPRO-1 Readout:** As detailed by our colleagues covering ORIC, we view the statistical bar as achievable given Ph1 combo data (14.3mo rPFS vs. ~6-8 months historical for physicians choice: Xtandi or docetaxel), with control-arm performance and crossover dynamics as key swing factors. We note PFE's powering assumption was mevro 10 months PFS.
- **GS Modeling and Illustrative Stock Impact:** We currently include mevro as part our other PhII/III assets and do not model separately vs. Visible Alpha Consensus Data of $3.2b/$1.5bn unadjusted/adjusted global adjusted sales in 2035. **On potential stock moves, we note that every 0.25x move in PE multiple represents ~3% upside/downside based on our 9.0x multiple valuation, and anticipate there could be a move of such magnitude, with potential upside convexity if it prompts more of a sentiment change.**

Valuation and Risks

PFE (Neutral).

Valuation: We derive our 12-month price target of $26 through a 9.0x multiple applied to our Q5-Q8 adjusted EPS. Our updated 2026/2027/2028 EPS estimates are $2.99/$2.96/$2.57 vs. $2.99/$2.95/$2.56 prior, as we incorporate near-term prescription trends and recent developments.

Upside risks include: Greater-than-expected impact of cost-savings efforts as well as lower-than-expected Part D headwind could result in upside to our EPS estimates. Potential positive development of the oncology franchise could lead to upside to our medium-to-long-term estimates, in addition to potential multiple expansion of the stock. While we are conservative on the vaccine franchise due to potential headwinds to the commercial and regulatory outlooks, stabilization in the vaccine franchise could lead to upside to our estimates and improved sentiment on the stock.

Downside risks include: Setback of late-stage pipeline assets could result in downside to our long-term estimates and further multiple compression. As a significant portion of the company's revenue is derived from the vaccine franchise, worse than expected regulatory and commercial outlooks on vaccines could lead to further downside to our vaccine estimates. Tariffs could have an outsized impact on the company's bottom-line relative to our coverage, given the company's lower-than-average gross margin.

PFE	12m Price Target: **$26.00**	Price: **$25.01**	Upside: **4.0%**

Neutral

Market cap: $142.3bn
Enterprise value: $189.9bn
3m ADTV: $1.0bn
United States
Americas Pharmaceuticals
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue ($ mn) New	**62,579.0**	**61,933.1**	**60,284.9**	**54,234.4**
Revenue ($ mn) Old	62,579.0	62,431.5	60,257.0	54,072.1
EBITDA ($ mn)	28,561.0	28,482.0	28,267.7	24,987.7
EBIT ($ mn)	21,969.0	21,979.6	21,558.9	19,144.8
EPS ($) New	**3.22**	**2.99**	**2.96**	**2.57**
EPS ($) Old	3.22	2.99	2.95	2.56
P/E (X)	7.7	8.4	8.5	9.7
Dividend yield (%)	6.8	6.7	6.9	7.0
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	1.8	1.7	1.5	1.5

	3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
EPS ($)	0.75	0.69	0.88	0.68

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 23 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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Contributing Authors: Asad Haider, CFA Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Nick Jennings Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Jeff Su Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC.

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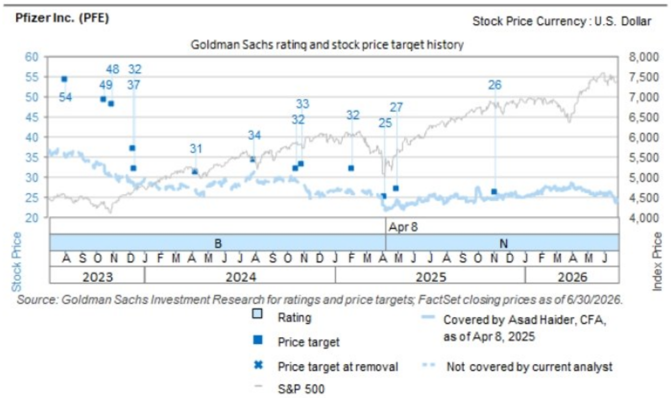

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Target price history table(s)

Pfizer Inc. (PFE)

Date of report	Target price ($)	Closing price ($)
05-Nov-25	26.00	24.61
30-Apr-25	27.00	24.41
08-Apr-25	25.00	21.84
05-Feb-25	32.00	26.44
30-Oct-24	33.00	28.52
21-Oct-24	32.00	28.93
31-Jul-24	34.00	30.54
11-Apr-24	31.00	26.34
14-Dec-23	32.00	26.13
11-Dec-23	37.00	28.64
01-Nov-23	48.00	30.51
18-Oct-23	49.00	31.41
02-Aug-23	54.00	35.35

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